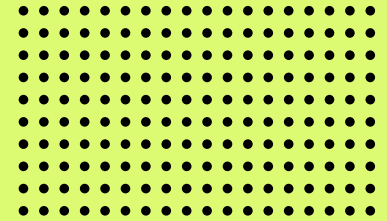


Lawhive - Hackathon 2026



CASE BRIEF / MESSY, SEVERE

CASE 09

I THINK I WAS SACKED FOR RAISING A COMPLAINT AND THE
COMPANY HAS PUT A SETTLEMENT OFFER ON THE TABLE V.01

LONDON 30/05/26

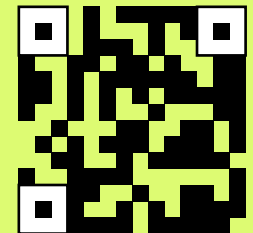
MESSY, SEVERE



CLAIMANT

Leah Miller

34, Sale, Manchester



SPONSORED BY

ANTHROP\C

Google Cloud

Balderton.

I think I was sacked for raising a complaint and the company has put a settlement offer on the table

Leah Miller, 34, Sale, Manchester

PROBLEM, IN THE CLIENT'S OWN WORDS

I worked as an operations manager at a logistics company for three years. About four months ago I raised a formal grievance about my line manager, specifically about bullying behaviour and being repeatedly passed over for promotion in favour of less experienced male colleagues.

The grievance was investigated internally and 'not upheld'. Two weeks after the outcome letter, I was called into a meeting and told my role was being made redundant. I was the only one out of a team of nine. They said it was a restructure but I don't believe that for a second.

I appealed the redundancy decision. It took four weeks and was also unsuccessful, they said the selection criteria were fairly applied but they never actually showed me the scoring matrix despite me asking for it.

I contacted ACAS on my own and started early conciliation. The company participated but barely. The ACAS certificate has been issued. I checked the certificate and the tribunal deadline on it is actually 3 September 2026, so I do have some time to file an ET1 — but the company has now put a settlement offer in front of me and that offer expires in five days. It is for one month's salary and I think it is far too low. I need help deciding whether to accept, reject, or come back with a counter, and I'd like to understand what I might realistically recover at tribunal if I walked away from settlement.

I should also mention, during the appeal process I sent a long email to the CEO. I was frustrated and emotional. I said some things like 'this company is rotten from the top down' and 'I have never been treated with such contempt'. I also mentioned that I had recordings of conversations with my manager. I made those recordings on my phone without telling him. I know this might cause problems but I was trying to protect myself.

One more thing on the money side. My annual bonus for last year (they call it the STIP) of £5,340 was paid into my account on 27 March 2026, in the same payslip as my March salary. I was already on notice by then — the redundancy letter was dated 4 March. I had a quick read of my contract and there's a clause that says you have to be employed and not under notice on the date the bonus would be paid, otherwise you don't get it. I don't know whether HR will try to claw the £5,340 back from my final pay because they paid it by mistake, or whether the fact that they paid it anyway means they've effectively waived that clause. I'd also like to know whether I can claim for the bonus I would have received next March (March 2027) — on plan that would be about £8,000 — given that I won't be employed by the time the next bonus cycle pays out.

I think I have a strong case but the settlement clock is ticking and I've probably made some mistakes along the way. Please help.

CASE 09 / MESSY, SEVERE / PROBLEM STATEMENT

EMPLOYMENT - DISMISSAL - CASE - 09

KEY INFORMATION

Client	Leah Miller
Employer	Granthorne Logistics
Line manager	Daniel Morley
Role	Operations manager, three years' service
Grievance outcome	Not upheld
Redundancy	Sole role made redundant in a team of nine
ACAS conciliation	Concluded, certificate issued (Ref. R263214/26/98)
Effective date of termination (EDT)	04 June 2026
ET1 deadline (s.111(2) ERA 1996)	Midnight, Thursday 3 September 2026
Live settlement offer	One month's gross salary (£4,450). Offer expires in five (5) days.
STIP (annual bonus)	FY25/26 STIP of £5,340 paid in March 2026 payslip (pay date 27/03/2026) — paid after notice was given on 04/03/2026. Contract cl. 8.3 forfeits STIP if employee is "under notice" on the payment date. FY26/27 STIP (on-target ~£8,010, payable March 2027) will not be paid because Leah will not be employed by then.

DOCUMENTS PROVIDED

#	FILE NAME	DESCRIPTION
01	employment_contract.pdf	Contract showing role, start date (three years ago), salary, notice period and the recording policy at clause 16.
02	grievance_letter.pdf	Leah's formal grievance letter detailing bullying behaviour and examples of being passed over for promotion.
03	grievance_outcome_letter.pdf	HR letter stating the grievance was 'not upheld' following investigation.
04	redundancy_notification.pdf	Letter notifying Leah her role was being made redundant, citing a departmental restructure. She is the only named affected employee.
05	redundancy_appeal_letter.pdf	Leah's appeal lodged within 7 days of the redundancy notification.
06	appeal_outcome_letter.pdf	Letter confirming the redundancy appeal was unsuccessful. States 'the selection criteria were fairly applied' but does not include or reference the scoring matrix.
07	acas_certificate.pdf	ACAS Early Conciliation certificate (Ref. R263214/26/98) showing the conciliation period and the s.111(2) ET1 deadline (Thursday 3 September 2026).
08	email_to_ceo.pdf	Leah's email to the CEO during the appeal. Lengthy and emotional, includes 'rotten from the top down' and 'treated with such contempt'. References covert recordings of conversations with her line manager.
09	employer_settlement_offer.pdf	Email from the HR director offering one month's gross salary as a full and final settlement during ACAS conciliation. The offer is expressed to be open for seven (7) calendar days from the date of the email and the seven-day window closes in five (5) days.
10	payslips.pdf	Last six months of payslips showing salary, bonuses, and pension contributions.